
Subject: Information from Sugar Creek Presbyterian Church

From: Jane Jolly <mjolly937@gmail.com>

To: jimmy.wead@gmail.com

Date Sent: Thursday, March 26, 2026 6:24:40 PM GMT-05:00

Date Received: Thursday, March 26, 2026 6:24:58 PM GMT-05:00

Attachments: PXL_20260326_231552935.MP.jpg,PXL_20260326_231616736.MP.jpg,PXL_20260326_231536920.MP.jpg

Dear Mr. Wead,

This information is from a self published book by Dr. Virginia F. Rainey, former member of Sugar Creek. She spent countless hours researching many documents and records including many not held by our church to compile this history. I scanned my copy and found the paragraph you see below that reference your relative.

Jane Jolly

CHAPTER X

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THE BABYLONIAN EXILE

Only a remnant, like Israelites returning from Babylon, survived in the original church. One quarter of the Caesar's Creek congregation accepted the discipline of the Associate Synod. These survivors requested reorganization and supply in December 1842. For the first year though, the Free Associates controlled the meeting house. They permitted the Associates to use the building only on their own terms, including the demand to pay the Free Associate sexton William Cherry. By September 1843 the two groups were quarrelling bitterly over the allocation of the use of the church and division of the paraments and furnishings. Major James Galloway of Xenia was suing his cousin George Junkin, who had stayed in the fold, while the Caesar's Creek Associates, prompted by James Morrow, were suing to regain ownership of the meeting house.¹

Apparently Galloway contemptuously referred to Morrow as a "wireworker," in modern parlance, a "string-puller." Morrow was so incensed that, when Galloway refused to open the letters containing Morrow's rebuttal, instead sending them back unread, Morrow published the letters at his own expense. In them Morrow bitterly accused Heron of having always been wandering and wavering in his theology. Heron, he said, had been lax and had left a wreck of a congregation in Virginia, escaping retribution there only by slipping into the Caesar's Creek pulpit. Morrow found it incredible that Washington University in Virginia had recently rewarded Heron with an honorary doctorate and hinted that the degree was a figment of Heron's imagination.²

At the west end of the county, Sugar Creek was in turmoil. From August 1843 to November 1845, no session meetings were recorded. Worse yet, the congregation split over the course to be followed. Most of the congregation proudly followed George Hall into exile, as had many of Massie's Creek and about a quarter of Xenia. It was not until January 1844 that the Sugar Creek Associates were reestablished. The twenty-six communicants who remained included Paulina Tate and Eb Andrew, Nancy and Mary Law, Susan Tate, and the Abercrombies, Dodds, Thompsons, Watts, and Weads [Wades]. When Samuel Wilson called an organizational congregational meeting in March 1844, Ebenezer Andrew, Nathan Thompson, and John Stewart Wade Jr. were elected to be the elders.³

These elders were new faces to Sugar Creek leadership. John Stewart Wead, now most often spelled Wade, was a son of Elizabeth Winter and John Sr. Along with several sisters and brothers, he had joined Sugar Creek in the 1830's. He was a grandson of Molly and Stephen Winter, most of whose family with affiliated with Massie's Creek. Wade Jr. was married to Sarah. Ebenezer Andrew was one of the youngest children of Elizabeth Morrow Andrew, born in Nashville in 1800. He was a farmer married to Paulina Tate, who raised nine children of her own in addition to his son James White by his first wife Hannah White. The session was completed by a relative newcomer Nathan Thompson, who had joined Sugar Creek in 1836 with his wife

**INTO GREENE PASTURES: MASSIE'S CREEK*SUGAR CREEK*XENIA
ASSOCIATE PRESBYTERIAN CHURCHES, 1798-1991**

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Revised, August 1997

Elizabeth and their daughter Rachel.

For three years these determined Seceders were without a settled pastor. Because there were just too few of them to support a minister, they petitioned presbytery in July 1846 to link them with the Caesar's Creek congregation. Upon receiving approval, the yoked congregations issued a call to licentiate Cyrus Cummins of Philadelphia Presbytery. Preaching from Jeremiah 3:15, Rev. James Wallace of Cherokee ordained Cummins at Caesar's Creek on November 22.⁴

Cyrus Cummins was born in Lewiston, Pennsylvania, in 1812. There he attended Washington College, graduating in 1841, which he followed by seminary and licensure on July 11, 1844. Until November 1854 he preached three Sundays a month at Caesar's Creek and one at Sugar Creek. It would appear that his new position was personally as well as professionally a positive one, for upon receipt of his call, he married a young lady of the Xenia congregation, Nancy Collins. She was the second daughter of Eleanor Wallace Collins; three of her brothers became U.P. ministers. They had four children.⁵

Cyrus had a position to stretch his energy, for the Caesar's Creek minutes record repeated visits by members to hear those preachers connected with those suspended by the Associate Church. James Morrow and John Chalmers were ever present at session meetings to contest Cummins's handling of affairs. After one acrimonious attack by Chalmers, Cummins so lost his temper that the presbytery stepped in to mediate.⁶ By at least 1850, he also had responsibilities toward a preaching station in Clinton County known as Union, where communion was observed occasionally. This may be the mission in Wilson Township later served by Presbyterian ministers from Wilmington; that congregation merged into Wilmington Presbyterian Church in June 1890. Or Union may have been connected with Associate congregations in Sabina or Wilmington, both of which were ephemeral.⁷

By the 1850's Caesar's Creek Associate Church was again a viable congregation, but Sugar Creek was dwindling. Soon after Cummins had come to Sugar Creek, recently remarried Nathan Thompson was released from the session and moved away. Cummins did not replace him. Eb Andrew represented Sugar Creek at presbytery and Synod. In November 1854 Cummins asked presbytery for permission to demit his charge of Sugar Creek in order to concentrate on Caesar's Creek. He continued there until 1861, finally outliving James Morrow, who died in 1855. After Cummins' resignation, the pulpit was filled by supplies, beginning with Rev. Moses M. Oldham in 1855. In 1856 and 1857, the chore rotated among Oldham, Cummins, and old friend Thomas Beveridge Jr., who had returned to Xenia as a professor at the Associate Seminary, which moved to Xenia in 1855. Despite their efforts, the number of Sugar Creekers attending Associate services declined until in 1857 only seven families with eighteen communicants still adhered to the Associate branch.⁸

Surprisingly, despite the unpleasantness of the sectarian strife, the sons of the early pioneers took steps during this period to become the leadership of the next generation of the Associate church. Three grandsons of Mary Torrence became ordained ministers. John Torrence Tate, born to Mary and deacon Hugh Tate in 1820, a member of Sugar Creek who married Nancy